

# Paid Media Campaign Performance & Creative Strategy

A practical Media Buyer assessment focused on campaign diagnosis, creative performance, decision making and actionable creative direction.

| 01                                                 | 02                                      | 03                                            |
|----------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| DIAGNOSE                                           | DECIDE                                  | DIRECT                                        |
| Review campaign evidence<br>Find reliable patterns | Scale what works<br>Pause what does not | Turn insight into<br>clear creative direction |

## Project at a glance

|                   |                                                     |
|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Role focus        | Media Buyer / Paid Media Specialist                 |
| Channel           | Meta Ads                                            |
| Core focus        | Creative performance, CPA, testing and optimization |
| Business scenario | Performance focused wellness ecommerce campaign     |
| Product exercise  | Daily Balance                                       |

Portfolio note: This is a structured assessment using a fictional product scenario. The value of the project is the decision process, analysis framework and creative thinking rather than a claim of live client revenue.

# 01 What was the project?

The assignment was a Media Buyer test designed to evaluate how I think when campaign performance data needs to become a clear business decision. The work had two connected parts. First, I had to diagnose Meta creative performance and decide what deserved more budget, what should be paused and what needed more testing. Second, I had to turn the performance evidence into a practical brief for an external creative agency.

## What I was given

|                              |                                                                                                                          |
|------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Campaign objective</b>    | Assess creative performance over a 30 day Meta advertising period and identify reliable winners and meaningful patterns. |
| <b>Performance benchmark</b> | Target CPA of \$45 or below, with \$800 budget per ad and at least 20 conversions for a reliable sample.                 |
| <b>Decision requirement</b>  | Recommend one ad to scale, one to pause and one to continue testing, while separating facts from assumptions.            |
| <b>Creative requirement</b>  | Develop direction for three distinct long form Meta video concepts for the fictional Daily Balance product.              |
| <b>Audience</b>              | Women aged 28 to 45 in the United States who are busy, health conscious and cautious about exaggerated wellness claims.  |

## The product and creative guardrails

Daily Balance was defined as a powdered daily wellness supplement used once each morning. The approved positioning focused on everyday energy, general wellbeing and convenience. The creative also had to remain credible and practical, avoid medical claims, avoid guaranteed outcomes and avoid unsupported statistics or before and after promises.

## 02 My diagnosis and problem solving

I approached the assignment as a performance problem first and a creative problem second. The goal was not simply to find the ad with the lowest CPA. The goal was to understand whether the result was reliable enough to influence the next budget decision.

| STEP | QUESTION I ASKED           | DECISION                                                                       |
|------|----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 01   | Is the result reliable?    | Check CPA against the \$45 target and confirm the 20 conversion threshold.     |
| 02   | Which format is strongest? | Compare blended CPA across long form video, short form video and static image. |
| 03   | What can be repeated?      | Look for a winning angle appearing across more than one format.                |
| 04   | What should happen next?   | Separate scale, pause and test decisions using evidence.                       |

### The core diagnosis

A good paid media decision needs enough evidence behind it. A low CPA alone is not automatically a winner if the conversion volume is too small. I therefore treated the CPA target and conversion threshold as a combined decision rule. I then looked beyond individual ads to understand whether a format or creative angle was consistently producing stronger economics.

| Campaign data                                    | Performance signal      | Pattern               | Action                      |
|--------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------------|
| <b>Spend</b><br><b>Conversions</b><br><b>CPA</b> | <b>Reliable or weak</b> | <b>Format + angle</b> | <b>Scale / Pause / Test</b> |

### Problem solving tasks I completed

- Screened the creative set against the target CPA and reliability threshold.
- Compared blended CPA by creative format rather than judging formats from a single ad.
- Identified repeatable creative angles that could be tested across different formats.
- Separated direct evidence from inference so recommendations did not overstate what the data could prove.
- Converted performance insights into specific creative direction for the next production cycle.

## 03 From diagnosis to creative direction

The second part of the project required a brief that an external agency could actually use. Instead of writing finished scripts, the task was to give the creative team enough strategic direction to produce strong first drafts.

|                   |                         |                                                                                                                  |                        |
|-------------------|-------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| <b>CONCEPT 01</b> | <b>The Busy Morning</b> | Lead with a familiar morning problem and position the product as a simple addition to an existing routine.       | Credible and practical |
| <b>CONCEPT 02</b> | <b>The Daily Ritual</b> | Show how one small daily habit can fit naturally into a busy schedule without making exaggerated promises.       | Warm and encouraging   |
| <b>CONCEPT 03</b> | <b>Simple Choice</b>    | Focus on convenience, product clarity and the reasons a sceptical customer may prefer a straightforward routine. | Clear and reassuring   |

### Creative direction I would carry into production

|                       |                                                                                                          |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Hook</b>           | Create immediate relevance in the first few seconds and show the product early.                          |
| <b>Narrative</b>      | Keep the story grounded in a real daily routine rather than relying on dramatic claims.                  |
| <b>Format</b>         | Build vertical 60 to 90 second videos suitable for Meta placements with captions.                        |
| <b>Product role</b>   | Make the product visible early and keep its role clear throughout the story.                             |
| <b>Call to action</b> | Finish with the approved message: Start your daily routine.                                              |
| <b>Compliance</b>     | Avoid disease claims, guaranteed results, invented statistics and unsupported before and after outcomes. |

## 04 Final perspective

The strongest part of this project was the connection between analysis and action. I was not only looking at campaign numbers. I was using those numbers to decide what deserved another dollar, what needed to stop and what should be tested next.

|                             |                                                                                                                                   |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>PERFORMANCE THINKING</b> | I used CPA and conversion volume together so a result had to be both efficient and reliable before it became a scaling signal.    |
| <b>CREATIVE THINKING</b>    | I looked for patterns across formats and angles so the next creative cycle could build on evidence instead of starting from zero. |
| <b>MEDIA BUYING</b>         | The focus stayed on budget decisions, performance signals and the relationship between creative quality and campaign economics.   |
| <b>EXECUTION</b>            | The final output translated the diagnosis into a brief that a creative team could use immediately.                                |

| <b>DIAGNOSE</b>       | <b>OPTIMIZE</b>       | <b>SCALE</b>           |
|-----------------------|-----------------------|------------------------|
| Understand the signal | Improve the next test | Invest behind evidence |

### Portfolio positioning

Paid Media Campaign Breakdown: Strategy, Optimization & Results

This project demonstrates practical experience in campaign performance analysis, creative testing, media buying decisions, optimization thinking and performance focused creative strategy.